Tuka Ram believed in a formless God. According to him, it was not possible to enjoin spiritual joy with worldly activities. He stressed the all-pervasiveness of God. He rejected Vedic sacrifices, ceremonies, pilgrimages, idol worship, etc. He also preached the virtue of piety, forgiveness and peace of mind. He spread the message of equality and brotherhood. He tried to foster Hindu-Muslim Unity. Some of his verses are devoted to this theme. He wrote his *abhangas* in Marathi



Tuka Ram

13.6 Impact of the Bhakti Movement

Salvation which was previously considered attainable, only by people of the first three orders in the social hierarchy became available to everyone. Bhakti movement provided women and members of the lower strata of the society an inclusive path to spiritual salvation. Literature on devotional songs in regional languages became profuse. The poet-saints of this movement championed a wide range of philosophical positions, ranging from theistic dualism of Dvaita, to absolute monism of Advaita. Much of the regional practices such as community singing, chanting together of deity names, conducting festivals, going on pilgrimages, performing rituals relating to Saivism, and Vaishnavism have survived to this day.

SUMMARY

- The protest and resistance of Jains and Buddhists to the authority of Orthodox Vedic religion by making religion accessible to all, without caste or gender bias is dealt with
- The persecution of Jains and Buddhists by Saivites with royal patronage is discussed
- The transformation of Vedic religion while conflicting with Jainism and Buddhism is explained
- The spread of bhakti cult to north India and its salient features are examined
- Impact of Sufism on Islam and its influence in the evolution of a monotheistic religion especially Sikhism are analyzed
- The major proponents of bhakti movement and the impact of their work in the north India are highlighted

EXERCISE

S6I2K9

I. Choose the Correct Answer

1. _____ provided Hinduism with a philosophic doctrine of Advaita.
   (a) Adi Sankara (b) Ramanuja
   (c) Ramananda (d) Chaitanya
2. _____ refers to the conflict between the orthodox Vedic sects and Shramanic sects.
   (a) Ramayana (b) Bagavatha purana
   (c) Hagiographies (d) Bal lila
3. _____ was known as Koon Pandyan.
   (a) Mahendravarman I
   (b) Maravarman Arikesari
   (c) Narasimhavarman
   (d) Sundara Pandyan
4. Appar as a Jaina was known as _____
   (a) Harisena (b) Theerthankara
   (c) Sivagnana Sithiyar (d) Dharmasena
5. Fakir is the term used for_____
   (a) Muslim saint (b) Buddhist
   (c) Hindu ascetic (d) Sikh guru
6. Madhavacharya belonged to the philosophical school of _____
   (a) Dwaita (b) Advaita
   (c) Visistadvaita (d) Pushti marga
7. _____ was one of the disciples of the Bhakti saint-poet Ramananda.
   (a) Chaitanya (b) Mirabai
   (c) Guru Nanak (d) Kabir

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